SSC CHSL 2021 Tier-I question paper with answers

2 June 2022 · Shift 2

85 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 15 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20220816140307/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2021_16082022.pdf

English Language 24 questions

Q.1

Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them contains a grammatical error. Select the option that has the error. When you have worked out this sum, you may went out to play.

(A) When you have worked out
(B) went out to play
(C) this sum
(D) you may

Q.2

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Going to the weekly market / in every Tuesday / is a ritual that has been followed / by generations in my family.

(A) is a ritual that has been followed
(B) by generations in my family
(C) in every Tuesday
(D) Going to the weekly market

Q.3

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Despair

(A) Vile
(B) Hope
(C) Annoy
(D) Definite

Q.4

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Audience
(B) Comprehension
(C) Competence
(D) Attendence

Q.5

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Wax

(A) Wane
(B) Mourn
(C) Error
(D) Insolent

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underline segment in the given sentence. It was apparent that the girl was “heading into” a serious disaster.

(A) heading along
(B) heading for
(C) heading down
(D) heading out

Q.8

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined group of words. He requested the bank to give him more time as at present he was “unable to pay his debts.”

(A) Destitute
(B) Meticulous
(C) Reckless
(D) Bankrupt

Q.9

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Dark horse

(A) A person criticised
(B) Loved person
(C) An unexpected winner
(D) A champion

Q.10

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. The people will make him the leader.

(A) He had been made the leader by people.
(B) He will be made the leader by the people.
(C) He was made leader by the people.
(D) People made him the leader.

Q.11

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. I know him.

(A) I am known to him.
(B) He is known to myself.
(C) He is known to me.
(D) Let him be known to me.

Q.12

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. Mahatma Gandhi in undoubtedly one of the “much” popular authors of our times.

(A) best
(B) total
(C) most
(D) better

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution required’. Sheela “is trying” for a job since last year.

(A) was trying
(B) have been trying
(C) No substitution required
(D) has been trying

Q.14

In the following passage, a word has been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Gifting is generally taken to be the easiest act to _____, if only you have the heart to part with something in your _____.

(A) forsake, capacity
(B) perform, possession
(C) forgive, discretion
(D) observe, control

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. He is a _____ in shining armour.

(A) knit
(B) nite
(C) night
(D) knight

Q.16

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. However, after studying the myths scientifically, only a simpleton would find them irrational or worthless. B. Moreover, it is wrong to analyse myths on the yardstick of their factual accuracy as they were designed to serve a greater, deeper purpose. C. Myths have always been regarded as a complex and intriguing aspect in human life D. In modern scientific world, they are essentially seen as something unscientific and meaningless.

(A) DCAB
(B) DACB
(C) ACDB
(D) CDAB

Q.17

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Be like chalk and cheese

(A) Be absolutely lonely
(B) Be absolutely rich
(C) Be absolutely deceptive
(D) Be absolutely different

Q.18

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word 'Lead' from the given sentence. All the class monitors were asked to follow the guide who was there to manage and control their visit to Yamuna Biodiversity Park.

(A) Control
(B) Follow
(C) Guide
(D) Manage

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. I "had get back from" Hyderabad last month.

(A) got back from
(B) had got back
(C) get back from
(D) had got back from

Q.20

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Salubrious

(A) Beneficial
(B) Vicarious
(C) Insidious
(D) Septic

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. While I was sitting there (1)_____ over my failure to keep from having to spend (2) glistering _____ summer months on the freaking Cote of Azur, Grandmere started (3)_____ me from the phone. She kept (4)_____ her fingers on the phone to catch my attention. I just sat there blinking at her until finally she put her hand over the receiver and (5)_____ (so that nobody listens), "Amelia! In my bedroom, there is something for you".

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) smirking
(B) sulking
(C) grinning
(D) clapping

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. While I was sitting there (1)_____ over my failure to keep from having to spend (2) glistering _____ summer months on the freaking Cote of Azur, Grandmere started (3)_____ me from the phone. She kept (4)_____ her fingers on the phone to catch my attention. I just sat there blinking at her until finally she put her hand over the receiver and (5)_____ (so that nobody listens), “Amelia! In my bedroom, there is something for you”.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) ours
(B) me
(C) my
(D) mine

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. While I was sitting there (1)_____ over my failure to keep from having to spend (2) glistering _____ summer months on the freaking Cote of Azur, Grandmere started (3)_____ me from the phone. She kept (4)_____ her fingers on the phone to catch my attention. I just sat there blinking at her until finally she put her hand over the receiver and (5)_____ (so that nobody listens), “Amelia! In my bedroom, there is something for you”.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) disconcerting
(B) beckoning
(C) upsetting
(D) dismissing

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. While I was sitting there (1)_____ over my failure to keep from having to spend (2) glistering _____ summer months on the freaking Cote of Azur, Grandmere started (3)_____ me from the phone. She kept (4)_____ her fingers on the phone to catch my attention. I just sat there blinking at her until finally she put her hand over the receiver and (5)_____ (so that nobody listens), “Amelia! In my bedroom, there is something for you”.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) piquing
(B) snapping
(C) peering
(D) tapping

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. While I was sitting there (1)_____ over my failure to keep from having to spend (2) glistering _____ summer months on the freaking Cote of Azur, Grandmere started (3)_____ me from the phone. She kept (4)_____ her fingers on the phone to catch my attention. I just sat there blinking at her until finally she put her hand over the receiver and (5)_____ (so that nobody listens), “Amelia! In my bedroom, there is something for you”.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) commended
(B) cheered
(C) lauded
(D) hissed

General Intelligence 19 questions

Q.1

Study the given pattern carefully and select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in it. First row- 5, 39, 8; Second row- 7, 36, 5; Third row- 11, ?, 9 (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is NOT allowed)

(A) 60
(B) 40
(C) 50
(D) 70

Q.2

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 6:96 :: 8:144 :: 5:?

(A) 70
(B) 90
(C) 85
(D) 75

Q.3

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1.Catalyst 2.Carrot 3. Calcium 4. Calculate 5.Calendar

(A) 4,3,5,2,1
(B) 4,5,3,2,1
(C) 3,4,5,2,1
(D) 3,2,1,4,5

Q.4

Three Statements are given followed by Three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All moons are suns. No moon is a star. Some stars are planets. Conclusions: I. Some suns are planets. II. No sun is a star. III. No planet is a moon.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(B) None of the conclusions follow.
(C) Both conclusions I and III follow.
(D) Only conclusion II follows.

Q.5

The second number in the given number pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number pairs except one. Find that odd number pair.

(A) 43:84
(B) 21:40
(C) 15:210
(D) 19:36

Q.6

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 16*6*69*81*3

(A) −,+,x,=
(B) ×,−,=,÷
(C) ÷,+, =,×
(D) +,=,×,−

Q.7

Which of the following letter-clusters will replace the question mark (?) in the given series to make it logically complete? TVX, SUW, RTV, QSU, ?

(A) TRP
(B) RPT
(C) TPR
(D) PRT

Q.8

Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the sixth term is related to the fifth term. 19 : 90 :: 25 : ? :: 13 : 60

(A) 120
(B) 100
(C) 115
(D) 110

Q.9

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. (The words must be considered as meaningful English words and must NOT be related to each other based on the number of letters/number of consonants/vowels in the word) Golf : Stick :: Cricket : ?

(A) Bat
(B) Stadium
(C) Ball
(D) Wicket

Q.10

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 127*13*3*129*41

(A) +,=,+,−
(B) −,×,=,−
(C) ÷,−,=,−
(D) −,−,=,+

Q.12

If A denotes '+', B denotes '×', C denotes '−' and D denotes '÷', then what will come in place of '?' in the following equation? 17 A (31 B 3) C (64 D 8) A 41 C (21 B 4) = ?

(A) 69
(B) 59
(C) 61
(D) 55

Q.13

In a certain code language, 'MOTHER' is written as 'LNSGIV' and 'FATHER' is written as 'ZUSGIV'. How will 'WONDER' be written in that language?

(A) DLWMIV
(B) DLMWIV
(C) LDWMIV
(D) LDMWVI

Q.18

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 99*25*10*12*7

(A) −,=,+,×
(B) +,=,+,×
(C) −,+,=,×
(D) −,=,+,+

Q.19

If 31 December 2009 was Thursday, then what was the day of the week on 25 December 2010?

(A) Monday
(B) Sunday
(C) Saturday
(D) Tuesday

Q.20

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 16*4*8*10*2*43

(A) ÷,×,−,+, =
(B) ÷,×,+,−, =
(C) ×, ÷,−,+, =
(D) +,×,−,÷,=

Q.21

In a certain code language, 'ACTOR' is written as '136812' and ‘HEROINE’ is written as ‘95128745’. How will 'HERO' be written in that language?

(A) 95128
(B) 95768
(C) 95218
(D) 95378

Q.22

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 314, 285, 308, ?, 306, 293, 304

(A) 277
(B) 298
(C) 287
(D) 289

Q.23

Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? CIEO, JAAU, QSWA, XKSE,?

(A) FCOI
(B) ECOI
(C) ECRI
(D) FCRI

Q.25

Select the option that is related to the fifth word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word and the fourth word is related to the third word. (The words must be considered as meaningful English words and must NOT be related to each other based on the number of letters/number of consonants/vowels in the word) Elephant : Trunk :: Fish : Gill :: Kangaroo : ?

(A) Antlers
(B) Pouch
(C) Blowhole
(D) Muzzle

Quantitative Aptitude 17 questions

Q.1

Ruksana travelled at 60 km/h while going from point A to point B, and returned via the same route at a different speed. If Ruksana’s overall average speed during the two-way journey was 48 km/h, what was her speed while travelling from B to A?

(A) 42 km/h
(B) 40 km/h
(C) 45 km/h
(D) 36 km/h

Q.2

What distance will be covered by a bus moving at 108 km/h in 40 seconds?

(A) 1 km 600 m
(B) 1 km 400 m
(C) 1 km 800 m
(D) 1 km 200 m

Q.3

An arc on a circle that is 15 cm long subtends a 24° angle at the centre. What is the circumference of the circle?

(A) 240 cm
(B) 220 cm
(C) 236 cm
(D) 225 cm

Q.4

The ratio of the radii of two right circular cylinders is 2 : 3. If their heights are in the ratio 5 : 3, find the ratio of their volumes.

(A) 16 : 19
(B) 3 : 4
(C) 3 : 1
(D) 20 : 27

Q.5

An article is sold at a discount of 10% and an additional discount of 40% is allowed on cash payment. If Anita purchased an article by paying ₹2,700 in cash, the marked price of the article was:

(A) ₹5,000
(B) ₹2,500
(C) ₹2,000
(D) ₹5,500

Q.6

A dealer allows his customers a discount of 15% and still gains 15%. If an article cost ₹2,500 to the dealer, then its marked price is (correct to nearest integer):

(A) ₹3,382
(B) ₹4,382
(C) ₹1,312
(D) ₹3,182

Q.7

The lengths of a pair of parallel sides of a trapezium are 20 cm and 25 cm, respectively, and the perpendicular distance between these two sides is 14 cm. What is the area (in cm^2) of the trapezium?

(A) 512
(B) 250
(C) 300
(D) 315

Q.8

The average of six integers is 48. The average of the first five integers is 70% of the sixth integer. The sixth integer is.

(A) 64
(B) 62
(C) 68
(D) 58

Q.9

Two numbers X and Y are such that the sum of 18% of X and 8% of Y is one-third of the sum of 22% of X and 36% of Y. Find the ratio of X and Y.

(A) 2 : 5
(B) 3 : 11
(C) 3 : 8
(D) 8 : 3

Q.10

Simplify the following expression. $79 - [6 - \{4 - (8 \times (6+3))\}] \div 2$

(A) 11.5
(B) 2.5
(C) 37
(D) 42

Q.12

What is the compound interest on ₹10,625 for 2 years at 8% interest per annum, if interest is compounded annually?

(A) ₹1,768
(B) ₹1,698
(C) ₹1,625
(D) ₹1,528

Q.13

The smallest four-digit number which is divisible by 4, 8, 12 and 16 is:

(A) 1010
(B) 1008
(C) 1006
(D) 1012

Q.19

A man sold a radio set and gained one-eighth of its cost price. What is the profit percent?

(A) 20%
(B) 12.5%
(C) 15.5%
(D) 18%

Q.22
A pipe can fill a tank in 15 hours. Due to leakage in the bottom it is filled in 20 hours. If the tank is full, and the pipe is closed, how much time will the leak take to empty the entire tank?

(A) 60 hrs
(B) 50 hrs
(C) 40 hrs
(D) 30 hrs

Q.23
Find the 4th proportional to 5, 10 and 12.

(A) 8
(B) 24
(C) 48
(D) 20

Q.24
A man borrowed some money and returned it in two equal instalments of ₹3,025 each. If the rate of interest is 10% per annum, compound annually, find the sum borrowed.

(A) ₹5,575
(B) ₹6,250
(C) ₹6,525
(D) ₹5,250

Q.25
In an election between two candidates, one of the candidates secured 35% of the votes cast and was defeated by the other candidate by 1296 votes. If there were no invalid votes, then the total number of votes polled was:

(A) 4546
(B) 4230
(C) 4456
(D) 4320

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1
Which of the following instruments is played by P Mani Iyer?

(A) Sarangi
(B) Violin
(C) Mridangam
(D) Mandolin

Q.2
Who among the following authors won the Kamaladevi Chattopadhyay NIF Book Prize in the year 2019?

(A) Ornit Shani
(B) Jairam Ramesh
(C) Milan Vaishnav
(D) Dinyar Patel

Q.3
The election of the next Vice-President is to be held within _____ of the expiry of the term of office of the outgoing Vice-President.

(A) 90 days
(B) 60 days
(C) 120 days
(D) 75 days

Q.4
In the Jayamma vs state of _____ case, in May 2021, the Supreme Court observed that dying declarations are admissible in evidence on the principle of necessity, as there is little hope of the maker surviving.

(A) Andhra Pradesh
(B) Karnataka
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) Kerala

Q.5
Which method of calculating the national income is also known as ‘Industrial Origin Method’?

(A) Expenditure Method
(B) Income Method
(C) Value Added Method
(D) Monetary Measures Method

Q.6

The famous folk musician Bhupen Hazarika belongs to which of the following states?

(A) Assam
(B) Odisha
(C) Madhya Pradesh
(D) Karnataka

Q.7

Ustad Amjad Ali Khan, a renowned musician from India is known for playing which of the following instruments?

(A) Sarod
(B) Jaltarang
(C) Sarangi
(D) Veena

Q.8

Which of the following dance forms is performed by Guru Vempati Chinna Satyam?

(A) Manipuri
(B) Odissi
(C) Bharatanatyam
(D) Kuchipudi

Q.9

Modhera Dance Festival is an annual cultural phenomenon in the _____ district of the state of Gujarat.

(A) Junagadh
(B) Mehsana
(C) Amreli
(D) Anand

Q.10

How many passenger trains are there as per 2021 data?

(A) 19169
(B) 11169
(C) 13169
(D) 16169

Q.11

Kalamandalam Kshemavathy Pavithran was conferred the Padma Shri award for her contribution to which of the following dance forms?

(A) Kuchipudi
(B) Bharatanatyam
(C) Kathak
(D) Mohiniyattam

Q.12

Which of the following novels is written by Kiran Desai?

(A) The Ministry of Utmost Happiness
(B) The Inheritance of Loss
(C) Midnight's Children
(D) The Golden House

Q.13

C V Chandra Shekhar was conferred the Padma Bhushan for his contributions to which of the following forms of Dance?

(A) Bharatanatyam
(B) Kathakali
(C) Manipuri
(D) Kathak

Q.14

In 1857, who was the first to experimentally demonstrate that the yeast responsible for making alcohol from sugar, and contaminating microorganisms found in normal air, could sour fermentation?

(A) Alexander Fleming
(B) Louis Pasteur
(C) Fanny Hesse
(D) Martinus Willem Beijerinck

Q.15
Which of the following Carnatic instruments is performed by Rajna Swaminathan?

(A) Violin
(B) Flute
(C) Veena
(D) Mridangam

Q.16
Who among the following sportspersons is one of the Arjuna Award 2021 winners?

(A) Vikas Kumar
(B) Nishad Kumar
(C) Bajrang Punia
(D) P V Sindhu

Q.17
Which phylum of the plant kingdom consists of vascular plants, leaves (known as fronds), roots and sometimes true stems and entire trunks in tree ferns?

(A) Angiosperm
(B) Pteridophyta
(C) Bryophyta
(D) Gymnosperm

Q.18
Who observed that in a mixture of non-reactive gases, the total gas pressure is equal to the sum of the partial pressures of the individual gases?

(A) Antoine Lavoisier
(B) John Dalton
(C) Amedeo Avogadro
(D) Robert Boyle

Q.19
Which cycle shows the movement of water?

(A) Carbon cycle
(B) Nitrogen cycle
(C) Geological cycle
(D) Hydrological cycle

Q.20
Which of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

(A) Arun Jaitley cricket stadium - Bengaluru
(B) Bharat Ratna Atal Bihari Vajpayee Cricket Stadium - Lucknow
(C) Narendra Modi cricket stadium - Ahmedabad
(D) Eden Garden - Kolkata

Q.21
The autobiography 'My Experiments with Truth' was originally written in which language?

(A) English
(B) Bengali
(C) Gujarati
(D) Marathi

Q.22
Who among the following secured one of the two silver medals for India at the Tokyo Olympics 2020?

(A) Ravi Kumar Dahiya
(B) Sushil Kumar
(C) Bajrang Punia
(D) KD Jadhav

Q.23
Which chemical compound is composed of magnesium, sulphur and oxygen and is commonly used in detox bath to relax muscles and relieve pain in the shoulders, neck, back and scalp?

(A) Epsom salt
(B) Potash alum
(C) Rock salt
(D) Glauber's salt

Q.24

The term 'dribble' is used in which of the following sports?

(A) Basketball
(B) Baseball
(C) Badminton
(D) Tennis

Q.25

Which climate zone has an average temperature of over 64°F (18°C) throughout the year and more than 59 inches of rainfall each year?

(A) Tropical zone
(B) Temperate zone
(C) Dry zone
(D) Continental zone

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(D)**

General Intelligence

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(C)**
Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(B)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(D)**	

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (B) went out to play

The modal 'may' takes the base form of the verb: 'you may go out to play'.

Q.2 · Answer (C) in every Tuesday

Days take 'on', not 'in', and 'every Tuesday' can stand without a preposition: 'Going to the weekly market every Tuesday is a ritual ...'

Q.3 · Answer (B) Hope

'Despair' is the complete loss of hope; its opposite is 'hope'.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Attendence

The correct spelling is 'attendance'.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Wane

To 'wax' is to grow, as the moon does before it is full; its opposite is to 'wane', to shrink.

Q.6 · Answer (B) heading for

To be 'heading for' something, usually trouble, is to be on course for it: 'heading for a serious disaster' is the set phrase.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Bankrupt

A person unable to pay his debts is 'bankrupt'. 'Destitute' means without the basic necessities of life, 'meticulous' very careful and 'reckless' heedless of danger.

Q.9 · Answer (C) An unexpected winner

A 'dark horse' is a little-known competitor who unexpectedly wins or does well.

Q.10 · Answer (B) He will be made the leader by the people.

The future active 'will make' becomes 'will be made', with 'him' as the subject 'he' and the agent kept: 'He will be made the leader by the people.'

Q.11 · Answer (C) He is known to me.

In the passive 'know' takes 'to', not 'by'. The object 'him' becomes the subject 'he', and 'I' becomes 'me': 'He is known to me.'

Q.12 · Answer (C) most

'One of the' is followed by a superlative: 'one of the most popular authors'. (The 'in' before 'undoubtedly' is the paper's misprint for 'is'.)

Q.13 · Answer (D) has been trying

An action that began in the past ('since last year') and is still going on takes the present perfect continuous; with the singular subject 'Sheela', 'has been trying'.

Q.14 · Answer (B) perform, possession

An act is 'performed', and what one parts with is something in one's 'possession'.

Q.15 · Answer (D) knight

A 'knight in shining armour' is a chivalrous rescuer; 'night' and 'nite' only sound the same, and to 'knit' is to make fabric from yarn.

Q.16 · Answer (D) CDAB

C introduces myths, D says the modern scientific world sees them as meaningless, A ('However') counters that view and B ('Moreover') adds a further point: CDAB.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Be absolutely different

Two people or things 'like chalk and cheese' are completely different from each other.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Follow
To 'lead' is to go ahead and guide others; its opposite in the sentence is 'follow'.

Q.19 · Answer (A) got back from
A completed action at a stated past time ('last month') takes the simple past: 'I got back from Hyderabad last month.'

Q.20 · Answer (A) Beneficial
'Salubrious' means health-giving or wholesome: 'beneficial'.

Q.21 · Answer (B) sulking
She was 'sulking', silently resentful, over her failure; smirking, grinning and clapping would all show pleasure.

Q.22 · Answer (C) my
The possessive 'my' goes before the noun phrase: 'to spend my glistering summer months' (the sheet prints the blank after 'glistering'). 'Mine' stands alone, and 'me' is an object pronoun.

Q.23 · Answer (B) beckoning
Grandmere started 'beckoning' the narrator from the phone, signalling to her to come over.

Q.24 · Answer (D) tapping
She kept 'tapping' her fingers on the phone to catch the narrator's attention.

Q.25 · Answer (D) hissed
To 'hiss' is to speak in a sharp, low whisper, as she does with her hand over the receiver.

General Intelligence

Q.1 · Answer (A) 60
In each row the middle number is three times the sum of the other two: (5 + 8) × 3 = 39 and (7 + 5) × 3 = 36. So (11 + 9) × 3 = 60.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 75
The second number is the first times (the first + 10): 6 × 16 = 96 and 8 × 18 = 144. Likewise 5 × 15 = 75.

Q.3 · Answer (C) 3,4,5,2,1
In dictionary order: Calcium (3), Calculate (4), Calendar (5), Carrot (2), Catalyst (1). 'Calci' comes before 'Calcu', 'Calc' before 'Cale', and 'Cal', 'Car' and 'Cat' in that order.

Q.4 · Answer (B) None of the conclusions follow.
Nothing links the stars that are planets to suns, so I is not certain. Suns that are not moons may be stars, so II is not certain. Planets that are not stars may be moons, so III is not certain either.

Q.5 · Answer (C) 15:210
In 43:84, 21:40 and 19:36 the second number is twice the first minus 2. For 15 that gives 28, not 210, so 15:210 is the odd pair.

Q.6 · Answer (B) ×,−,=,÷
16 × 6 − 69 = 81 ÷ 3: the left side is 96 − 69 = 27 and the right side 27.

Q.7 · Answer (D) PRT
Each letter moves one place back each time: T, S, R, Q, P; V, U, T, S, R; X, W, V, U, T. The next cluster is PRT.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 120
The second number is five times one less than the first: 18 × 5 = 90 and 12 × 5 = 60. Likewise 24 × 5 = 120.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Bat
In golf the ball is struck with a stick (club), and in cricket with a bat.

Q.10 · Answer (B) −,×,=,−
127 − 13 × 3 = 129 − 41: the left side is 127 − 39 = 88 and the right side 88.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 59
After replacing the letters: 17 + (31 × 3) – (64 ÷ 8) + 41 – (21 × 4) = 17 + 93 – 8 + 41 – 84 = 59.

Q.13 · Answer (C) LDWMIV
Each letter is replaced by its opposite in the alphabet (A ↔ Z, B ↔ Y ...) and each pair is then reversed: MO TH ER → NL GS VI → LN SG IV, and FA → UZ → ZU. So WO ND ER → DL MW VI → LD WM IV: LDWMIV.

Q.18 · Answer (C) –,+,=,×
99 – 25 + 10 = 12 × 7: both sides are 84.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Saturday
2010 is not a leap year, so 31 December 2010, 365 days (52 weeks and 1 day) later, was a Friday. 25 December 2010 is 6 days earlier: Saturday.

Q.20 · Answer (D) +,×,–,÷,=
16 + 4 × 8 – 10 ÷ 2 = 43: 16 + 32 – 5 = 43.

Q.21 · Answer (A) 95128
Each letter has its own number. HEROINE (95128745) gives H = 9, E = 5, R = 12, O = 8, I = 7 and N = 4, and ACTOR (136812) confirms O = 8 and R = 12. So HERO = 9 5 12 8: 95128.

Q.22 · Answer (D) 289
The differences are –29, +23, –19, +17, –13, +11: the primes from 29 down, alternately subtracted and added. So 308 – 19 = 289, and 289 + 17 = 306.

Q.23 · Answer (B) ECOI
First letters move 7 forward (C, J, Q, X, E, wrapping round after Z), second letters 8 back (I, A, S, K, C), third letters 4 back (E, A, W, S, O), and the fourth letters run through the vowels (O, U, A, E, I): ECOI.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Pouch
Each animal is paired with a body part that marks it out: the elephant's trunk, the fish's gills and the kangaroo's pouch.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 · Answer (B) 40 km/h
Over equal distances the average speed is 2uv/(u + v): 2 × 60 × v/(60 + v) = 48, so 120v = 2,880 + 48v, 72v = 2,880 and v = 40 km/h.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 1 km 200 m
108 km/h = 108 × 5/18 = 30 m/s, so in 40 seconds the bus covers 1,200 m: 1 km 200 m.

Q.3 · Answer (D) 225 cm
The arc is 24/360 = 1/15 of the circumference, so the circumference is 15 × 15 = 225 cm.

Q.4 · Answer (D) 20 : 27
Volume is $\pi r^2 h$, so the ratio is $(2^2 \times 5) : (3^2 \times 3) = 20 : 27$.

Q.5 · Answer (A) ₹5,000
After 10% and then 40% off, 0.9 × 0.6 = 0.54 of the marked price is paid: 2,700 ÷ 0.54 = ₹5,000.

Q.6 · Answer (A) ₹3,382
Selling price = 2,500 × 1.15 = ₹2,875, which is 85% of the marked price: 2,875 ÷ 0.85 = ₹3,382.35, or ₹3,382.

Q.7 · Answer (D) 315
Area = ½ × (sum of the parallel sides) × height = ½ × (20 + 25) × 14 = 315 cm^2.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 64
The six add up to 6 × 48 = 288. With the sixth integer x, the first five add up to 5 × 0.7x = 3.5x, so 4.5x = 288 and x = 64.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 3 : 8
0.18X + 0.08Y = (0.22X + 0.36Y)/3, so 0.54X + 0.24Y = 0.22X + 0.36Y and 0.32X = 0.12Y. X : Y = 0.12 : 0.32 = 3 : 8.

Q.10 · Answer (D) 42
Innermost first: 6 + 3 = 9, 8 × 9 = 72, 4 – 72 = –68 and 6 – (–68) = 74. Then 74 ÷ 2 = 37, and 79 – 37 = 42.

Q.12 · Answer (A) ₹1,768
Amount = 10,625 × 1.08^2 = 10,625 × 1.1664 = ₹12,393, so the interest is 12,393 – 10,625 = ₹1,768.

Q.13 · Answer (B) 1008
The LCM of 4, 8, 12 and 16 is 48. 1,000 ÷ 48 leaves 40, so the smallest four-digit multiple is 1,000 + 8 = 1,008 (48 × 21).

Q.19 · Answer (B) 12.5%
A gain of one-eighth of the cost price is 1/8 × 100 = 12.5%.

Q.22 · Answer (A) 60 hrs
The leak empties 1/15 – 1/20 = 1/60 of the tank an hour, so it empties the full tank in 60 hours.

Q.23 · Answer (B) 24
If 5 : 10 = 12 : x, then x = 10 × 12/5 = 24.

Q.24 · Answer (D) ₹5,250
The sum borrowed is the present value of the two instalments: 3,025/1.1 + $3,025/1.1^2$ = 2,750 + 2,500 = ₹5,250.

Q.25 · Answer (D) 4320
The winner got 65% and the loser 35%, so the margin is 30% of the votes = 1,296. Total = 1,296 ÷ 0.3 = 4,320.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Mridangam
Palghat Mani Iyer was one of the great mridangam players of Carnatic music.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Ornit Shani
Ornit Shani won the 2019 prize for 'How India Became Democratic: Citizenship and the Making of the Universal Franchise'.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 60 days
SSC's key gives 60 days. Article 68 requires only that the election be completed before the outgoing Vice-President's term ends; under the Presidential and Vice-Presidential Elections Act, 1952 it is notified on or after the sixtieth day before that date, so it is held within the last 60 days of the term.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Karnataka
In Jayamma v. State of Karnataka (May 2021) the Supreme Court held that a dying declaration may on its own support a conviction, but must be scrutinised with great care.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Value Added Method
The value added (product) method adds up the value added by every producing unit, grouped by the industry or sector it belongs to; hence 'industrial origin method'.

Q.6 · Answer (A) Assam
Bhupen Hazarika, the singer and composer from Assam, was awarded the Bharat Ratna posthumously in 2019.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Sarod
Amjad Ali Khan is one of India's best-known sarod players.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Kuchipudi
Vempati Chinna Satyam was a great guru of Kuchipudi, the classical dance of Andhra Pradesh.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Mehsana
The Modhera Dance Festival is held at the Sun Temple at Modhera, in Mehsana district.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 13169
SSC's key gives 13,169, the number of passenger trains Indian Railways reports running daily on its long-distance and suburban routes.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Mohiniyattam
Kalamandalam Kshemavathy is a leading Mohiniyattam dancer and teacher from Kerala.

Q.12 · Answer (B) The Inheritance of Loss
Kiran Desai's 'The Inheritance of Loss' won the Booker Prize in 2006. Arundhati Roy wrote 'The Ministry of Utmost Happiness', and Salman Rushdie 'Midnight's Children' and 'The Golden House'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Bharatanatyam
C. V. Chandrasekhar is a Bharatanatyam dancer, choreographer and teacher.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Louis Pasteur
In his work on fermentation from 1857 Louis Pasteur showed that it is carried out by living microorganisms: yeast turns sugar into alcohol, while other microbes from the air can turn it sour.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Mridangam
Rajna Swaminathan is a mridangam player and composer, a student of the mridangam master Umayalpuram K. Sivaraman.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Nishad Kumar
Para high jumper Nishad Kumar, a silver medallist at the Tokyo Paralympics, received the Arjuna Award in 2021. Bajrang Punia and P. V. Sindhu had received theirs years earlier.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Pteridophyta
Pteridophytes, the ferns and their relatives, were the first plants with vascular tissue and true roots, stems and leaves; a fern's leaves are called fronds.

Q.18 · Answer (B) John Dalton
This is Dalton's law of partial pressures, stated by John Dalton in the early 1800s.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Hydrological cycle
The hydrological (water) cycle moves water between the oceans, the air and the land by evaporation, condensation, precipitation and run-off.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Arun Jaitley cricket stadium - Bengaluru
The Arun Jaitley Stadium, formerly the Feroz Shah Kotla, is in Delhi; Bengaluru's is the M. Chinnaswamy Stadium.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Gujarati
Gandhi wrote his autobiography in Gujarati; Mahadev Desai translated it into English.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Ravi Kumar Dahiya
Wrestler Ravi Kumar Dahiya won silver in the men's 57 kg freestyle; India's other silver was weightlifter Mirabai Chanu's. Bajrang Punia won bronze.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Epsom salt
Epsom salt is hydrated magnesium sulphate, $MgSO_4 \cdot 7H_2O$.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Basketball
To dribble in basketball is to bounce the ball continuously while moving with it.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Tropical zone
Tropical climates, near the equator, are warm all year, every month averaging 18°C or more, and wet; the temperate, dry and continental zones are cooler or drier.

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